GRADE 5 ELA QUESTION BANK

Topic 5: Poetry, Figurative Language, and Literary Devices

150 multiple-choice questions • 50 Easy • 50 Medium • 50 Hard

Instructions: Choose the best answer. The difficulty levels are kept in separate blocks: Easy questions 1–50, Medium questions 51–100, and Hard questions 101–150. The answer key is at the end.

EASY QUESTIONS (1–50)

Figurative Language and Comparison

1. Which phrase is a simile?

A. The clouds were cotton
B. The clouds covered the sun
C. The clouds looked gray
D. The clouds moved like ships

2. “The wind whispered through the trees” is an example of—

A. end rhyme
B. hyperbole
C. personification
D. stanza

3. Which phrase is a metaphor?

A. as cold as ice
B. the lake was a mirror
C. cold like ice
D. the lake was very cold

4. Which word imitates a sound?

A. slow
B. crash
C. bright
D. soft

5. Which line uses alliteration?

A. Busy bees buzzed by
B. A flower opened
C. The bird flew south
D. The sky turned dark

6. Which detail appeals to the sense of taste?

A. a ringing bell
B. a scratchy sweater
C. a bright lamp
D. a bitter sip of cocoa

7. What is a stanza?

A. the final sound in a line
B. the poem's author
C. a group of lines in a poem
D. a word that describes a noun

8. Which line uses personification?

A. The clock sat on a desk
B. The clock was round
C. The alarm clock yelled at me
D. The clock showed seven

9. Which pair of words rhymes?

A. cat / cup
B. day / play
C. tree / stone
D. warm / wish

10. What is imagery?

A. language that helps readers picture or sense something
B. the number of lines in a poem
C. the name of a poem
D. a list of characters

Imagery, Mood, Tone, and Word Choice

11. Which line appeals to hearing?

A. The bread smelled warm
B. The blanket felt soft
C. The lemon tasted sour
D. The bell clanged loudly

12. “I have a mountain of homework” is an example of—

A. alliteration
B. rhyme
C. stanza
D. hyperbole

13. Which phrase creates a peaceful mood?

A. footsteps racing behind me
B. branches snapping in a storm
C. gentle waves under a pale sky
D. sirens shrieking in the street

14. What does the speaker of a poem mean?

A. the title of the poem
B. the voice speaking in the poem
C. the person who reads the poem
D. the person who prints the poem

15. Which word has a negative connotation?

A. scrawny
B. determined
C. confident
D. slim

16. Which line contains a metaphor?

A. The classroom was a zoo
B. My brother is like a bear
C. The rain fell like beads
D. The dog ran quickly

17. Which phrase appeals to touch?

A. a sweet smell
B. a sour orange
C. a loud drum
D. a rough, scratchy rope

18. What is the theme of a poem?

A. the pattern of capital letters
B. the place where it was printed
C. a message or lesson about life
D. the number of words

19. Which phrase is an example of alliteration?

A. a blue sky
B. tiny turtles tiptoed
C. under the bridge
D. near the house

20. Which line uses a simile?

A. The snow was a blanket
B. The snow fell like feathers
C. The snow was white
D. The snow covered the road

Sound, Rhyme, Rhythm, and Structure

21. What is rhyme?

A. similar sounds, often at the ends of lines
B. a group of lines
C. a comparison using like or as
D. an exaggerated statement

22. Which word most clearly creates a gloomy mood?

A. playful
B. bright
C. cheerful
D. dreary

23. Which line is literal rather than figurative?

A. The stars winked at me
B. The road swallowed the car
C. Rain covered the sidewalk
D. The sun smiled at us

24. Which phrase compares using “as”?

A. the world is a stage
B. the road swallowed us
C. as quiet as a mouse
D. the angry clouds

25. Which line uses onomatopoeia?

A. The pebble was gray.
B. Plop! The pebble hit the pond.
C. The water looked calm.
D. The pond was deep.

26. What is a poem's tone?

A. the speaker's attitude toward the subject
B. the number of stanzas
C. the feeling the reader gets only
D. the poem's length

27. Which line uses a metaphor for time?

A. Time moved like a train
B. Time passed slowly
C. Time was measured in hours
D. Time is a thief

28. Which is a visual image?

A. a soft scarf
B. a bitter taste
C. a loud whistle
D. a bright red kite

29. Which phrase could symbolize hope?

A. a dark, empty road
B. a broken alarm
C. a small light in darkness
D. a locked empty room

30. Which line has end rhyme?

A. The moon rose slowly
B. The moon shone bright / All through the night
C. The sky was dark
D. The stars were clear

Symbolism, Theme, and Inference

31. What is a refrain?

A. a line or phrase repeated in a poem
B. a comparison using like or as
C. a type of character
D. a line that never has rhythm

32. Which word suggests a joyful tone?

A. delighted
B. mournful
C. gloomy
D. bitter

33. Which detail appeals to smell?

A. a ringing bell
B. a rough stone
C. a bright sign
D. the scent of pine after rain

34. Which line shows motion?

A. The room was square
B. The bowl sat on a table
C. The stream raced over rocks
D. The lamp was yellow

35. Which phrase is a metaphor for sadness?

A. I felt unhappy
B. a storm inside my chest
C. tears fell slowly
D. sad as rain

36. Which word best completes a rhyme with “light”?

A. long
B. night
C. leaf
D. lamp

37. Which line gives an object a human action?

A. The shadows crept across the wall
B. The wall was gray
C. The room had windows
D. The shadows were long

38. Which line uses a sound word?

A. The bee was yellow.
B. The flower opened.
C. The garden was quiet.
D. Buzz! The bee flew past.

39. Which feature can help create rhythm?

A. the title's font
B. the page color
C. patterns of stressed and unstressed syllables
D. the number of nouns

40. Which line most clearly shows gratitude?

A. The wind bends the grass
B. A bird rests on a branch
C. Your kindness is a lantern for me
D. The road is made of stone

Analyzing a Poet's Choices

41. What is a rhyme scheme?

A. the number of metaphors
B. the pattern of rhymes at line endings
C. the poem's main character
D. the author's biography

42. Which phrase has a positive connotation?

A. confident and determined
B. lazy and careless
C. weak and useless
D. mean and cruel

43. Which line creates a sense of sound and movement?

A. The road was narrow
B. The car was red
C. The hill was steep
D. The wheels clattered down the hill

44. Which line contains a simile about speed?

A. Her shoes were thunder
B. She was a racing engine
C. The road swallowed her
D. She ran like an arrow

45. Which word best describes a poem's mood?

A. the line count
B. the book's size
C. the feeling it creates for readers
D. the writer's name

46. Which line contains a metaphor?

A. He spoke softly
B. His words were daggers
C. His words sounded like music
D. He said three words

47. Which phrase appeals to hearing?

A. leaves crackling underfoot
B. a sweet perfume
C. a lemon's sour taste
D. a silky ribbon

48. Which statement about a poem's title is sensible?

A. It may give clues about the subject or meaning
B. It never matters
C. It always tells the theme
D. It must rhyme with the last line

49. Which line uses personification?

A. The sun warmed the sand
B. The sun appeared at dawn
C. The sun was bright
D. The sun peeked over the hill

50. Which phrase best describes a poem's speaker?

A. the reader's friend
B. always the poet personally
C. the voice presenting the poem's words
D. the poem's final line

MEDIUM QUESTIONS (51–100)

Figurative Language and Comparison

51. Read: “The sidewalk swallowed the rain / while streetlights blinked awake.” Which device appears in both lines?

A. hyperbole
B. personification
C. allusion
D. end rhyme

52. In “Her apology was a paper bridge,” what does the metaphor suggest?

A. the speaker crossed a real bridge
B. the apology may be fragile or not strong enough
C. the apology was written on paper only
D. the apology was very loud

53. Which statement best distinguishes tone and mood?

A. Tone is the speaker's attitude; mood is the feeling created for readers
B. Tone is the setting; mood is the speaker
C. They always mean the same thing
D. Tone is the rhyme pattern; mood is the line count

54. A poem follows an ABAB rhyme scheme. What does this mean?

A. all four lines rhyme
B. only lines 1 and 2 rhyme
C. no lines rhyme
D. Lines 1 and 3 rhyme, and lines 2 and 4 rhyme

55. Which revision creates a more vivid image?

A. Rain happened that day
B. The weather was bad
C. The cold rain needled my cheeks
D. It was raining outside

56. A poet repeats a line after each stanza. What is a likely purpose?

A. to change the speaker every time
B. to fill space without a reason
C. to emphasize an important idea or feeling
D. to prove there is no theme

57. Which detail most strongly creates an ominous mood?

A. Sunlight warmed the garden bench
B. A door creaked open in the empty hall
C. Children laughed by the fountain
D. Fresh bread cooled by the window

58. A poem compares memories to “buttons in a jar.” Which meaning is most reasonable?

A. memories are collected and kept
B. the speaker is shopping
C. the jar is only the setting
D. memories are always made of metal

59. Which line uses alliteration most clearly?

A. A bird crossed the sky
B. The night was quiet
C. The stars are far away
D. Silver snakes slide silently

60. A poem uses short, abrupt lines during a chase. What effect is most likely?

A. the scene must feel calm
B. the poem must be a sonnet
C. the theme becomes obvious

D. the pace feels quick and urgent

Imagery, Mood, Tone, and Word Choice

61. What is enjambment?

A. when every line ends with a period
B. when all lines have equal syllables
C. when a thought continues beyond the end of a poetic line
D. when two words begin alike

62. Which phrase is a metaphor rather than a simile?

A. Hope shines like a candle
B. Hope is a candle in the dark
C. Hope burns as if it were fire
D. Hope is bright as a flame

63. A “rusted key” appears repeatedly in a poem about a family secret. What might it symbolize?

A. access to something hidden or forgotten
B. a brand-new beginning with no past
C. the weather outside
D. a loud sound

64. Which line uses assonance most clearly?

A. The slow road rolls home
B. The dog barked twice
C. Rain hit the roof
D. A bird sat still

65. A poem shifts from a storm to a calm morning. What should readers examine?

A. the poet's handwriting
B. only the number of letters in each word
C. whether the title is capitalized
D. how the shift changes mood or meaning

66. The phrase “the city is a furnace” appears in a poem about summer. What does it suggest?

A. the speaker is describing winter
B. the city is literally a factory furnace
C. the city feels intensely hot
D. the city has no buildings

67. Which line is an extended metaphor beginning to develop?

A. My mind is busy today
B. My mind is a garden; each question plants a seed
C. Questions were asked in class
D. The garden needs water

68. A poem repeats “still I rise” after descriptions of setbacks. What does the repetition emphasize?

A. a change to past tense
B. persistence and resilience
C. the absence of a speaker
D. confusion about the setting

69. Which feature is most useful when identifying rhythm aloud?

A. the pattern of beats and stresses
B. the author's age
C. the paper's color
D. the number of pages

70. What is symbolism?

A. a statement that must be literal
B. a word that always rhymes
C. a poem with four lines

D. an object or image representing a larger idea

Sound, Rhyme, Rhythm, and Structure

71. A poem describes a “golden cage.” What idea does this image suggest?

A. complete freedom without limits
B. a natural landscape with no barriers
C. beauty or comfort combined with confinement
D. a plain metal tool

72. Which question best helps a reader infer theme?

A. How many words are in the title?
B. Which letter appears most often?
C. What insight about life emerges from the speaker's experience?
D. Does every stanza have four lines?

73. Which line includes onomatopoeia?

A. The tree stood beside the path.
B. Crack! The branch snapped underfoot.
C. Leaves covered the ground.
D. The branch was old and dry.

74. What is a caesura?

A. a pause within a poetic line
B. a rhyme at the end of every stanza
C. a comparison using like
D. a repeated opening consonant

75. A poem starts humorously but ends in regret. What is the likely effect?

A. the speaker must be unreliable
B. the poem cannot have a theme
C. the mood must stay the same
D. the shift makes the speaker's feelings more complex

76. Which detail best supports the idea that a poem celebrates everyday work?

A. a locked door with no one nearby
B. a crown in an empty room
C. a storm destroying a bridge
D. hands rough from planting, baking, and building

77. Which phrase is a mixed metaphor?

A. the idea took root
B. the ship sailed at dawn
C. nip this problem in the bud before it sails
D. the plan grew slowly

78. Why might a poet choose free verse?

A. to avoid imagery
B. to shape rhythm and line breaks without a fixed traditional pattern
C. to ensure every line rhymes
D. to make every stanza the same length

79. Which line creates contrast through juxtaposition?

A. A child laughed beside the ruined wall
B. The day ended at sunset
C. The child walked along the road
D. The wall was made of brick

80. A poem's speaker says, “I praise the storm that broke my roof.” What should readers consider?

A. whether the statement is ironic or reveals an unexpected view
B. whether the roof is the only symbol
C. whether praise must be literal

D. whether all storms are helpful

Symbolism, Theme, and Inference

81. Which is the strongest way to support an interpretation?

A. guess the poet's private intention as fact
B. summarize the title only
C. give a reaction with no details
D. cite specific words or lines and explain their meaning

82. Which sound device repeats vowel sounds in nearby words?

A. alliteration
B. onomatopoeia
C. assonance
D. end rhyme

83. What can a change in line length contribute?

A. the number of characters
B. pacing, emphasis, or the shape of an idea
C. only the poem's publication date
D. a guaranteed change in speaker

84. “Winter in my heart” after a friendship ends most likely means—

A. a literal change in body temperature
B. emotional coldness or sadness
C. the poem's location
D. a cheerful celebration

85. Which line is a paradox?

A. The more I learned, the less I knew
B. Rain fell on the roof
C. The lamp glowed in the room
D. The bird flew over the fence

86. What is a volta in a poem?

A. a missing speaker
B. a repeated title
C. a line with no syllables
D. a turn or shift in thought or feeling

87. A seed survives winter and blooms in spring. What idea might this image suggest?

A. the speaker dislikes flowers
B. all plants grow without sunlight
C. renewal can follow a difficult time
D. winter lasts forever

88. A poet places a long pause before the final word. What might this emphasize?

A. the author's location
B. the number of stanzas
C. the final word's meaning or emotional weight
D. the title's spelling

89. Which phrase conveys mixed feelings?

A. I felt only anger
B. I missed the freedom, but feared the open road
C. I was completely delighted
D. I had no doubts at all

90. A recurring image changes from a closed window to an open one. What might this suggest?

A. a movement from isolation toward possibility
B. a change from summer to winter only
C. a change in the poet

D. a fixed meaning with no development

Analyzing a Poet's Choices

91. Which claim about a poem is best supported by evidence?

A. The title alone proves the theme
B. The poet definitely wrote it after a private argument
C. The poem means whatever someone first guesses
D. The repeated broken-wing image suggests vulnerability because it appears when the speaker describes loss

92. A poem uses short phrases, then longer flowing lines after forgiveness. What might this change show?

A. that the poem is a limerick
B. that structure has no meaning
C. that the speaker has disappeared
D. a release of tension

93. A “museum of unsent words” is a metaphor for—

A. having no memories
B. words becoming objects
C. unspoken thoughts being preserved and revisited
D. a real museum full of paintings

94. Which evidence might show that a speaker is unreliable?

A. the title contains a noun
B. the speaker's claims conflict with details in the poem
C. the speaker says “I”
D. the poem has four stanzas

95. A poem uses a steady rhyme pattern to describe a chaotic argument. What might this contrast do?

A. contrast controlled form with disorderly events
B. always create a happy mood
C. prove the argument never happened
D. have no possible effect

96. Which statement best describes an ambiguous ending?

A. it allows more than one reasonable interpretation
B. it can only be understood from biography
C. the writer forgot to finish
D. it proves the poem has no meaning

97. “The crown weighed less than the promise” in a poem about leadership suggests—

A. the poem has no figurative language
B. a crown is lighter than every promise
C. the speaker only likes jewelry
D. responsibility may matter more than status

98. A poem repeatedly addresses the sea as “you,” though it cannot reply. What technique is used?

A. end rhyme
B. literal dialogue
C. apostrophe
D. flashback

99. A poet's title seems cheerful, but the ending reveals grief. What should readers do?

A. assume the title is unrelated
B. reconsider the title in light of the ending
C. ignore the final stanza
D. conclude the poem has no mood

100. A poem shifts from “I” to “we” in its final stanza. What might this change suggest?

A. the setting definitely changes
B. the speaker connects a personal experience to a shared one
C. the poem must use end rhyme

D. the poem no longer has a speaker

HARD QUESTIONS (101–150)

Figurative Language and Comparison

101. Read: “I stitched the dawn to yesterday / and wore the seam beneath my coat.” Which interpretation is best supported?

A. the speaker carries the past into a new beginning
B. the poem is only about clothing
C. the speaker has forgotten yesterday
D. the speaker is literally sewing the sky

102. A poem uses “bright darkness” for a character who feels relieved and afraid. This is best understood as—

A. a literal description of lighting
B. onomatopoeia
C. an end-rhyme pattern
D. a paradox expressing mixed emotions

103. A poem repeatedly uses clocks, deadlines, and shrinking shadows. What idea may these images emphasize?

A. the speaker's job as a clockmaker
B. gardening techniques
C. time pressure or the passing of life
D. a humorous setting

104. A bird appears first behind glass and later flying over the sea. What might this development symbolize?

A. a change in bird species
B. a change in weather only
C. movement from restriction toward freedom
D. the speaker's dislike of water

105. A speaker praises a cruel leader with exaggerated compliments. Which device is likely used?

A. a simple simile
B. verbal irony
C. assonance alone
D. literal praise only

106. How can enjambment affect meaning?

A. a thought continues past a line break, delaying completion or adding emphasis
B. it makes every line a full sentence
C. it always creates perfect rhyme
D. it removes every pause

107. A poem's rhythm breaks suddenly when the speaker receives bad news. What is the likely effect?

A. it guarantees a comic mood
B. it adds an unrelated sound
C. the poem has no structure
D. the form mirrors the disruption in the speaker's experience

108. Which statement best explains how a symbol differs from a repeated image?

A. a symbol is always a person
B. the terms always mean the same thing
C. a symbol must repeat; a motif appears once
D. a symbol carries meaning beyond itself; a motif is an element that recurs

109. A poem about moving away repeats suitcases, doorways, and maps. What should a reader consider?

A. that the poem is a travel ad
B. only the number of images
C. how these images build ideas about leaving, change, and belonging
D. that each object is unrelated decoration

110. Which claim is best supported by textual evidence?

A. the poem means whatever a reader first guesses
B. the repeated broken-wing image suggests vulnerability because it appears during descriptions of loss
C. the poet definitely wrote it after one specific argument

D. the title alone proves the theme

Imagery, Mood, Tone, and Word Choice

111. A poem begins with clipped phrases and ends with long flowing lines after forgiveness. What might this structural change show?

A. a release of tension
B. that structure has no meaning
C. that the poem must be a sonnet
D. that the speaker stops existing

112. A “museum of unsent words” most likely suggests—

A. unspoken thoughts being preserved and revisited
B. a lack of memories
C. a real museum of paintings
D. words literally becoming art

113. Which evidence best supports the idea that a speaker is unreliable?

A. the speaker uses “I”
B. the poem has four stanzas
C. the title contains a noun
D. the speaker's confident claims conflict with details revealed in the poem

114. A poet uses regular rhyme to describe a chaotic argument. What might the contrast suggest?

A. the argument never happened
B. the rhyme scheme has no effect
C. the controlled form contrasts with the disorder being described
D. traditional rhyme always creates happiness

115. Which best describes an ambiguous ending?

A. it can only be understood through biography
B. it allows more than one plausible interpretation supported by the poem
C. the writer forgot to finish
D. it proves the poem has no meaning

116. “The crown weighed less than the promise” most likely suggests—

A. the speaker is describing jewelry only
B. responsibility may matter more than status
C. the poem has no figurative language
D. a crown is lighter than every promise

117. A poem's speaker repeatedly corrects their own statements. What might this reveal?

A. uncertainty or a changing understanding
B. a lack of poetic structure
C. an automatic rhyme scheme
D. that the speaker is absent

118. Which line creates a layered metaphor for memory?

A. I remember the beach
B. The beach was wide
C. The shells were small
D. Memory is a tide that returns with altered shells

119. A dash appears just before a confession. What effect might it create?

A. evidence the punctuation is accidental
B. proof that the confession is false
C. hesitation or a sudden change in thought
D. a rhyme scheme

120. How can a reader judge whether a poem's form supports its theme?

A. focus only on biography
B. count words only

C. examine how structure, rhythm, line breaks, and sound work with the ideas
D. assume form and meaning are unrelated

Sound, Rhyme, Rhythm, and Structure

121. A city is “a thousand separate windows, each holding a different moon.” What might this suggest?

A. the speaker is giving an architecture report
B. people share a place but have different private experiences
C. every window contains a real moon
D. the city has no people

122. A poem contains images of both leaving and returning. What is a careful interpretation?

A. it may explore a complicated relationship with home or belonging
B. the poem can have only one literal meaning
C. one image must be an error
D. the title alone settles the conflict

123. In which line does “the crown” stand for a king or government?

A. The crown was made of gold
B. The king wore a crown
C. A crown fell from a shelf
D. The crown announced a new law

124. “Silence is a room we built together” suggests that silence—

A. requires an empty room
B. is literally a building
C. means the speaker is an architect
D. may be a shared condition created by more than one person

125. Which interpretation is best supported by repeated doorway images and the speaker's hesitation at each threshold?

A. the poem means sadness only
B. the poem is definitely about a specific person
C. the images suggest choices or decisions
D. the first image determines every meaning

126. A final image changes the meaning of a symbol that appeared earlier. What effect can this create?

A. it makes interpretation impossible
B. it invites readers to rethink earlier parts of the poem
C. it removes all links to earlier stanzas
D. it proves the poem has no ending

127. What does it mean when a poem supports more than one reasonable interpretation?

A. the wording supports more than one reading connected to the poem's details
B. any interpretation is equally supported
C. unclear words make interpretation impossible
D. ambiguity means no theme exists

128. A compass spins whenever a speaker must choose. What might it symbolize?

A. difficulty finding direction or certainty
B. a reliable sense of purpose
C. a literal weather forecast
D. a completed journey

129. What is the best way to compare two poems about grief?

A. choose the sadder one without evidence
B. assume they say the same thing
C. compare only their titles
D. compare imagery, speakers, tone, structure, and conclusions using evidence

130. “The silence after the last note was another kind of music.” What does this paradox suggest?

A. the speaker dislikes music
B. there is no sound imagery

C. quiet can still carry emotional meaning
D. silence literally makes musical notes

Symbolism, Theme, and Inference

131. Which is the strongest analysis of a poem's final turn?

A. repeat the last line without analysis
B. explain how the shift changes or complicates earlier ideas
C. assume the last line is always the theme
D. ignore the earlier stanzas

132. A bridge is called “half promise, half warning.” What tension does this create?

A. the speaker has no mixed feelings
B. it may offer connection while also presenting risk
C. it is only a physical structure
D. it means every journey is safe

133. A poem's title seems cheerful, but the last stanza describes loss. What is a strong reading strategy?

A. reconsider the title's meaning after reading the ending
B. conclude the poem has no theme
C. assume the title is unrelated
D. ignore the ending

134. A poem shifts from “we” to “I” near the end. What should readers investigate?

A. whether the poet changed their name
B. whether the poem has rhyme
C. whether the shift is automatically an error
D. whether the shift changes the speaker's sense of shared or personal responsibility

135. Why might a poet break a familiar rhyme pattern at the climax?

A. it proves the poet cannot rhyme
B. it always means the poem is unfinished
C. the change may signal an emotional or thematic shift
D. it has no effect if there is a title

136. A locked gate appears throughout a poem, but the speaker ends by saying, “I stopped searching for the key.” What might this imply?

A. the speaker has found the key
B. the poem is about home repairs only
C. the speaker is changing their response to an obstacle
D. the gate has disappeared

137. Which evidence best supports a critique of consumerism?

A. the presence of a metaphor
B. repeated images of price tags, disposable goods, and people treated like products
C. one shopping bag with no context
D. the author's name

138. A lullaby-like rhythm accompanies an unsettling event. What effect may result?

A. an eerie contrast between soothing form and disturbing content
B. a shift to factual writing
C. proof the event is harmless
D. no mood at all

139. How should a reader use a reference to a myth in a poem?

A. assume the poem is ancient
B. assume every reader knows the myth
C. ignore nearby lines
D. use relevant associations and the poem's context to explain its effect

140. Which statement best explains how sound reinforces meaning?

A. every poem must use one sound device

B. sound never affects meaning
C. rhyme always contradicts the subject
D. harsh consonants may intensify a conflict scene when paired with violent actions

Analyzing a Poet's Choices

141. A poem's recurring color appears in different situations. What is the best analysis method?

A. give it one universal meaning without reading
B. ignore changes across stanzas
C. track where it appears and infer its meaning from context and change
D. assume it was chosen randomly

142. Which claim is strongest when interpreting a complex poem?

A. it means sadness because I feel sad
B. repeated doorway images suggest choices, supported by hesitation at each threshold
C. the poem is definitely about one real person
D. the first image decides all meanings

143. A poem's ending transforms a recurring symbol instead of fully resolving it. What can this do?

A. invite readers to reinterpret the symbol and earlier moments
B. prove the poem has no ending
C. remove every connection to earlier stanzas
D. make interpretation impossible

144. A poem describes “the last light in the window” as a guide. What interpretation is most reasonable?

A. it may represent hope or connection, depending on context
B. it always means danger in every poem
C. it must be a literal lighthouse
D. it has no possible symbolic meaning

145. Which detail most clearly suggests the speaker has mixed feelings about returning home?

A. I arrived at noon
B. The house has a blue roof
C. The street is two blocks long
D. The door feels familiar, yet the hallway seems strange

146. A poem uses the same image at the beginning and end, but the speaker's attitude changes. What should a reader notice?

A. the image must mean exactly the same thing
B. the ending is unrelated
C. the repeated image may gain a new meaning because of the speaker's change
D. the poem has no structure

147. Which approach best supports a comparison of poetic techniques?

A. list the poets' names only
B. identify specific devices in both poems and explain their effects
C. count lines without discussing meaning
D. describe personal preference only

148. A poem says, “I planted a question and harvested doubt.” What is the strongest interpretation?

A. the line describes a real crop
B. asking the question led to uncertainty or deeper reflection
C. the speaker has no doubts
D. the speaker is literally farming questions

149. A poem's central image changes meaning after the speaker learns a secret. What should a strong analysis explain?

A. how the new information changes the reader's understanding of the earlier image
B. why every image has one fixed meaning
C. why the title must be literal
D. only how many times the image appears

150. A poem ends with a question that is never answered. What is the most reasonable interpretation?

A. the question cannot contribute to theme
B. the speaker has no point of view
C. the poem is automatically incomplete
D. the unresolved question may invite readers to consider the poem's conflict

ANSWER KEY

Grade 5 ELA • Topic 5: Poetry, Figurative Language, and Literary Devices

Questions 1–50: Easy • 51–100: Medium • 101–150: Hard

1	D	31	A	61	C	91	D	121	B
2	C	32	A	62	B	92	D	122	A
3	B	33	D	63	A	93	C	123	D
4	B	34	C	64	A	94	B	124	D
5	A	35	B	65	D	95	A	125	C
6	D	36	B	66	C	96	A	126	B
7	C	37	A	67	B	97	D	127	A
8	C	38	D	68	B	98	C	128	A
9	B	39	C	69	A	99	B	129	D
10	A	40	C	70	D	100	B	130	C
11	D	41	B	71	C	101	A	131	B
12	D	42	A	72	C	102	D	132	B
13	C	43	D	73	B	103	C	133	A
14	B	44	D	74	A	104	C	134	D
15	A	45	C	75	D	105	B	135	C
16	A	46	B	76	D	106	A	136	C
17	D	47	A	77	C	107	D	137	B
18	C	48	A	78	B	108	D	138	A
19	B	49	D	79	A	109	C	139	D
20	B	50	C	80	A	110	B	140	D
21	A	51	B	81	D	111	A	141	C
22	D	52	B	82	C	112	A	142	B
23	C	53	A	83	B	113	D	143	A
24	C	54	D	84	B	114	C	144	A
25	B	55	C	85	A	115	B	145	D
26	A	56	C	86	D	116	B	146	C
27	D	57	B	87	C	117	A	147	B
28	D	58	A	88	C	118	D	148	B
29	C	59	D	89	B	119	C	149	A
30	B	60	D	90	A	120	C	150	D